
FRONT DESK GUEST SERVICES SOP

Prepared by Phil Lane, Front Desk Manager. Reviewed with Elaine Bradshaw, General Manager. This document standardizes front office procedures so every guest receives the same steady welcome, shift after shift. It supports training of new clerks; see also the training manual D02 and the shift roster X04.

1. Shift Open (7:00 AM)

- Unlock the front office, switch on the lobby lamps and the porch sign.
- Read the night clerk handoff log and note any guest issues from overnight.
- Confirm the day's arrivals and departures against the reservation system.
- Start the lobby coffee and set out the morning pastry tray by 7:15.
- Check the Monday 7:15 staff meeting agenda when applicable.

2. Guest Check-In

- Greet by name when the reservation is known; keep it warm and brief.
- Verify identification and the reservation details, including departure date.
- Confirm room type, rate, and any package such as breakfast or parking.
- Take the card on file for incidentals; explain the hold clearly.
- Walk through quiet hours, breakfast times, and the wifi code.
- Hand over keys, mark the room occupied, and note any special request.

3. Guest Check-Out

- Review the folio with the guest before settling.
- Resolve any disputed charge calmly; involve the manager if over the clerk limit.
- Process payment, print or email the receipt, and release the incidental hold.
- Ask about the stay; log any feedback for the morning meeting.
- Notify housekeeping the room is vacant for turnaround; see Hector's team.

4. Reservations and Phone

- Answer within three rings: Birchwood Valley Inn, this is the front desk.
- Capture name, dates, room preference, contact number, and email.
- Quote the current rate; never promise an upgrade without manager approval.
- Read back the confirmation number and the cancellation policy.
- Enter the booking immediately; do not rely on memory across a busy shift.

5. Housekeeping Coordination

Time	Action	Owner
7:30 AM	Share departures list with housekeeping	Front desk
11:00 AM	Confirm checkout rooms cleared for turnaround	Front / Hector
2:00 PM	Verify arrivals-ready room count	Hector
3:00 PM	Flag any early-arrival room rush	Front desk

6. Payment Handling

- A clerk may adjust a charge up to \$25 to resolve a clear error.
- Adjustments above \$25 require the front desk manager.
- Adjustments above \$150 require the general manager.
- Balance the cash drawer at shift end and record any variance.
- Never share a guest's information with a caller who cannot verify the booking.

7. Summer Season Notes

Summer season ramp-up begins in May and runs through foliage in October. Expect higher occupancy on weekends and during regional events. Cross train weekend clerks early, keep the pastry and coffee stocked for the larger crowd, and watch the arrivals-ready count closely on Friday afternoons. The seasonal readiness deck PP01 covers staffing in detail.

8. Difficult Situations

- Stay calm and lower your voice; never match a raised tone.
- Listen fully before responding; acknowledge the guest's concern.
- Offer what is within policy; escalate the rest to the manager.
- Document the incident in the shift log with time, room, and resolution.
- Safety issues go to the manager and, if needed, to emergency services first.

9. Shift Close

- Reconcile the drawer and the day's folios.
- Write a clear handoff log for the night clerk, Nancy.
- Confirm tomorrow's arrivals are entered and rooms assigned where possible.
- Tidy the lobby, refill brochures, and dim the lamps as directed.

Questions about this SOP go to Phil Lane, Front Desk Manager. This revision supersedes prior versions.

Appendix: Record Index and Notes

Front desk operating procedures for Birchwood Valley Inn.

Related records

Code	Record	Where kept
D02	New clerk training manual	Front office
X04	Front desk shift roster	Workbook
PP01	Summer season readiness deck	Manager file

Filing notes

- Review this SOP with Amy Soto during onboarding.
- Keep the printed copy at the front desk for reference.
- Update the revision date when procedures change.
- Coordinate housekeeping turnaround with Hector each morning.

This appendix is for the household's own record keeping. Document code P05. Retain with related papers; see the home inventory D05 for the full filing list.